Lecture 2-4 — DOM Class Manipulation

What this page covers

How to read, add, remove and toggle CSS classes on an element using the DOM API. We'll use `classList`, which is the easiest and safest way to manage classes.

Code Example

```
// Select the heading
var heading = document.querySelector("#heading");

// Log classes
console.log(heading.className); // string of classes
console.log(heading.classList); // DOMTokenList with useful methods

// Toggle class on click
heading.addEventListener("click", function(){
    heading.classList.toggle("highlighted");
    // reflect changes in visible output below
    document.getElementById('status').innerText = heading.className;
});

// initialize status
document.getElementById('status').innerText = heading.className;
```

Interactive Example

Click me to toggle highlight

Output:

Current class list:

Open the browser console to see the original console logs.

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Explanation (for beginners)

- **`querySelector`:** picks the element with the CSS selector you pass.
- **`className`:** returns a single string of all classes (less convenient to modify).
- **`classList`:** returns a list-like object with helpful methods: `add`, `remove`, `contains`, `toggle`.
- **`toggle`:** adds the class if it's missing, removes it if present — perfect for click handlers.

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